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Presidential Telephone Calls - Memorandum of Conversations 10/24/89 - 12/26/89

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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: The President's Telephone Call to Prime Minister Cavaco Silva of Portugal (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Anibal Cavaco Silva, Prime Minister
Notetaker: Robert L. Hutchings

DATE, TIME November 27, 1989, 12:16 - 12:34 p.m. EST
AND PLACE: The Oval Office

The President initiated the call. (U)

The President: Anibal, how are you? (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: Fine. How is your family? (U)

The President: Fine. I am calling to get advice from an old friend about my Malta meeting. (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: It is a very important one. (U)

The President: There will be no surprises to our allies and no deals. I will be ready to talk with him on a wide array of economic things. I want perestroika to succeed, as you do. (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: It is important that the allies be united to achieve good results in disarmament and other fields. We agreed on that in Paris. (U)

The President: That is good to hear. I heard that from other allies. I appreciate that the allies are meeting. I wanted your ideas. (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: There should be economic reforms, not just political changes such as election laws and liberalization. Without structural adjustment, I think they will not succeed. We Portuguese understand. We had a totalitarian takeover attempt. We had to make many changes to put market mechanisms in place, adopt constitutional changes, and revise the banking system. We support the changes in Eastern Europe and the Soviet Union, but we should not destabilize the alliances. The EC also agreed that we should not weaken transatlantic ties. (U)

The President: I agree. This is a timely meeting. We started talking with Gorbachev last summer. I am glad to hear we are thinking along the same lines. (U)

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Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: Will you discuss regional problems?
(U)

The President: Yes. Absolutely. We will talk about Afghanistan, Nicaragua, and also Angola, which you are very interested in. (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: Yes. I want to talk about this when I visit in January. (U)

The President: Yes. If you have thoughts about Angola before I leave for Malta, I would appreciate your personal message. You could hand it to our Ambassador. (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: Yes. I have been there recently and talked to President Dos Santos. I think it is time for a lasting peace. I will see about a personal message, although our Foreign Minister has come to your State Department. Dos Santos wants a solution; everyone does. He has a problem in his Party, but he is in control. He wants a dialogue with Savimbi. (U)

The President: That is encouraging. If you have further thoughts before Malta, please tell me. I look forward to our meeting. (U)

Prime Minister Cavaco Silva: All the success to your summit. We in Europe will be following it with great interest. (U)

The President: We will do our best. We won't let you down. (U)

-- End of Conversation --